

Therapy Approaches

Articulation Approach

When your speech and language therapist creates a therapy plan, there are different approaches that they can choose. There is no single intervention approach that works for every child and sometimes this may need to be changed. Based on current research and evidence based practice, your speech and language therapist will aim to select the right intervention to meet the needs of the child.



What is the articulation approach?

We work through steps of intervention starting with the target sound in isolation, then in syllables, words, sentences and conversation.

Articulation Approach

The articulation approach is used when children have difficulties in moving specific parts of their mouth to make speech sounds. In therapy the child will progress through a hierarchy of levels starting with the sound in isolation, then combine the target sound with a vowel and then move onto words, sentences and conversation.



What happens in therapy?

- Firstly, the therapist will begin with a range of listening or auditory discrimination activities to help the child to learn about the sound that they have difficulties with.
- The therapist will use specialist techniques to teach the child how to produce their tricky sound. This may involve the use of gestures, picture cue cards and other visuals and tips on how to move parts of their mouth.
- Once the child is able to produce their tricky sound the therapist will progress through a series of levels or steps: saying the sound on its own, then in consonant/vowel blends, followed by words, phrases and sentences.
- The sound may also be practiced in different word positions – in the middle and at the end of words.

EXAMPLE

A child is having difficulties in articulating the 's' sound in isolation and all word positions.

The therapist will use specialist techniques to elicit the sound in isolation.

SAMPLE WORD LIST

CV level: see, saw, sue, sah

Initial 's'	Medial 's'	Final 's'
sun	castle	bus
soup	pencil	mouse
sock	listen	dice

